



Digital video (the form in which Internet / streaming video is available) is encoded in a variety of ways. Each technique of encoding has its corresponding technique of decoding, and this is where codecs come in.

3.1 Getting The Codecs

Even experts find digital video formats confusing, because most video files consist of two elements: the container and the codec used inside that container.

A codec is a technique (compression algorithm) used to reduce the size of a video file. Usually, this means the discarding of some of the information in the file, but there are algorithms that do not discard information. These are known as lossy and lossless algorithms respectively. Some of the popular codecs are MPEG-1, MPEG-2, MPEG-4, Vorbis, and DivX.

The container describes the structure of the file: where the var-